

SPEAKER PROFILE

SIMPHIWE GWANA

EXECUTIVE · FACILITATOR · BROADCASTER
· COACH · STORYTELLER

"Pastor G" — Curator of Human Stories

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Prepared for talent positioning and representation by The SpeakersFirm

SIGNATURE POSITIONING

Simphiwe Gwana is a strategic voice at the intersection of leadership, governance, human development and story. He translates complex organisational realities into accessible, practical and emotionally intelligent conversations that challenge audiences to think, heal, lead and act differently.

Known affectionately as Pastor G, he combines executive credibility with the warmth of a broadcaster, the discipline of a facilitator, the insight of a coach and the authenticity of a man whose own life journey has taught him the power of identity, reconciliation and purpose.

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Simphiwe Gwana is an accomplished executive leader, strategic management specialist, governance practitioner and accredited facilitator with more than three decades of experience across public, private, developmental and non-profit environments. He is the Founder and Chief Executive Officer of MRG Consulting (Pty) Ltd, through which he provides management consulting, organisational development, facilitation and personal development services.

His career spans strategic planning, organisational transformation, performance management, policy development, programme and project management, environmental management, occupational health and safety, transport and logistics, stakeholder engagement, broadcasting and leadership development. He has advised and facilitated for government departments, municipalities, state institutions, educational organisations, private companies, small businesses and community-based organisations.

He is particularly effective in rooms where leaders must move beyond discussion into alignment and execution. His facilitation style combines structured thinking, critical inquiry, practical tools and strong audience connection. He is equally at home addressing an executive strategy retreat, facilitating a management-development programme, moderating a high-level dialogue, coaching an individual leader or engaging a national radio audience.

PROFESSIONAL VALUE PROPOSITION

- ❖ Executive insight grounded in extensive leadership and operational experience.
- ❖ The ability to connect governance, strategy and performance with the human realities of leadership.
- ❖ A distinctive broadcasting voice and storytelling presence that makes complex messages memorable.
- ❖ A practical, participatory facilitation approach that turns reflection into commitment and action.
- ❖ A coaching orientation informed by NeuroCoaching, NLP and multiBrain Integration Techniques (mBIT).
- ❖ Cross-sector credibility spanning public administration, business, community development, media and ministry.

CORE AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Leadership, Strategy & Governance

- Strategic planning and execution
- Corporate governance and board leadership
- Performance management and Balanced Scorecard systems
- Programme and project management
- Risk, compliance and ethical leadership
- Public administration and service-delivery improvement

Transformation, People & Communication

- Change and culture transformation
- Executive facilitation and stakeholder engagement
- Leadership coaching and mentoring
- Emotional intelligence and self-leadership
- Broadcasting, public speaking and storytelling
- Environmental, OHS and sustainability leadership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

MRG Consulting (Pty) Ltd | **July 2009 - Present**

Provides strategic leadership and management consulting services focused on organisational performance, governance, strategy, transformation, facilitation and human development. Leads business growth, stakeholder relationships, consulting assignments, executive engagements and multidisciplinary project delivery.

Chief Operations Officer

Ingcinga Investments (Pty) Ltd | **February 2019 - June 2025**

Provided strategic and operational oversight, strengthening governance, organisational performance, partnerships, resource management and stakeholder confidence. Led growth initiatives and supported negotiations involving strategic partnerships and investment opportunities.

Executive Consulting & Facilitation

- ❖ Facilitated strategic planning sessions, executive retreats, organisational reviews and strategy-performance dialogues.
- ❖ Developed strategic plans, annual performance plans, operational plans, service-delivery improvement plans and monitoring frameworks.
- ❖ Designed and supported Balanced Scorecard and performance-management systems.
- ❖ Led change-management and business-improvement interventions in municipalities and private organisations, including work within South Africa and the wider SADC region.
- ❖ Conducted business diagnostics, feasibility studies and turnaround-planning assignments, including business planning, funding mobilisation and operational improvement.
- ❖ Managed enterprise and socio-economic development initiatives across contractor, artisan, supplier, cooperative, skills and local economic development.

Earlier Executive & Operational Leadership

- ❖ Chief Executive Officer — Hyper Fuels (transport logistics).
- ❖ General Manager: Operations — Anax Logistics (transport logistics).
- ❖ General Manager: Community Services — Buffalo City Metropolitan Municipality.
- ❖ Environmental health, solid-waste and environmental-services leadership within local government.
- ❖ Project leadership for built-environment, environmental and community-development programmes.
- ❖ Public Relations Manager to an internationally recognised gospel artist for eight years.

SELECTED CAREER DISTINCTIONS

- ❖ Represented Buffalo City Municipality at the World Summit for Sustainable Development.

- ❖ Received advanced international exposure and training in waste management in Sweden, Honduras and the Netherlands.
- ❖ Managed municipal landfill, transfer-station, waste-minimisation and integrated-waste-planning programmes.
- ❖ Contributed to strategic and policy processes and supported the alignment of organisational plans with wider development priorities.
- ❖ Served in multiple board and non-profit leadership roles, including chairperson and finance-committee responsibilities.
- ❖ Built a broadcasting career spanning more than two decades and received Best Presenter recognition in three consecutive years.

EXECUTIVE FACILITATION, TRAINING & COACHING

Simphiwe is an accredited facilitator with the National School of Government and an ETD practitioner through the University of Fort Hare. He has also facilitated through Summat Institute and supported SMME operations mentorship through Aurik Business Accelerator.

Leadership & Public-Sector Programmes

- Strategic planning and management
- Strategic human resource management
- Programme and project management
- Public financial management, finance and budgeting
- Leadership for good governance
- Policy formulation and implementation
- Research methodology in the public service
- Communication and citizen-focused strategies
- Leading change
- Knowledge management, accountability and service delivery

Corporate & Organisational Programmes

- Change management and strategic management planning
- Monitoring and evaluation
- Risk management and occupational health and safety
- Emotional intelligence, mentoring and coaching
- Advanced business and report writing
- Customer service and stakeholder communication
- Records, supply-chain and financial management
- Environmental, waste and sustainable-development management

COACHING APPROACH

As a Certified NeuroCoach Mastery Coach, NLP Practitioner and mBIT Practitioner, Simphiwe creates conversations that move through reflection, identity, decision, execution and accountability. His approach is compassionate but challenging: he listens for both what is said and what remains unspoken, then helps individuals and teams convert insight into a clear commitment.

His strongest coaching themes include identity, confidence, purpose, leadership transitions, emotional intelligence, resilience, fatherlessness, people-pleasing, boundaries, personal accountability and legacy.

MEDIA, BROADCASTING & STORYTELLING

Simphiwe is a broadcaster, voice-over artist, podcast host, book-reading artist, drama actor and master of ceremonies. His media work includes independent contributions to the South African Broadcasting Corporation through educational voice work, SAFM drama and book-reading projects. His long-form radio experience has developed a rare ability to hold attention, draw out human stories and communicate with warmth across diverse audiences.

He is also the creator of The Voice Behind the Books and founder of The Home of Human Stories — platforms that use voice, conversation and storytelling to preserve memory, honour dignity and help people recognise the meaning within their own lives.

PERSONAL PROFILE & LIVED-EXPERIENCE AUTHORITY

Behind Simphiwe's professional profile is a deeply human story. After a 50-year search for his father, he experienced reconciliation when he was 50 and his father was 84. The restored relationship, including a long-awaited embrace and five meaningful years together, transformed his understanding of identity, confidence, forgiveness and belonging.

That journey gives him authentic authority to speak about fatherlessness, the search for identity, the people-pleasing trap, inherited family patterns and the courage required to heal. His message does not romanticise pain; it shows audiences how the hardest chapter can become a source of wisdom without becoming the title of their lives.

A former military veteran, pastor, entrepreneur, mentor and community builder, he carries a strong sense of service, sacrifice and legacy. His faith informs his commitment to dignity and hope while his professional discipline ensures that his presentations remain accessible, relevant and action-oriented for diverse audiences.

SIGNATURE SPEAKING THEMES

The People-Pleasing Trap

How identity, fear of rejection and the need for approval quietly limit leaders — and how to recover an authentic voice.

The Father Wound and the Search for Identity

A lived-experience conversation about absence, belonging, reconciliation and breaking generational patterns.

It Runs in the Family, but It Stops with Me

How individuals and leaders interrupt inherited dysfunction and choose a different legacy.

Becoming the Leader Your Future Is Waiting For

Moving from reflection to identity, decision, execution and accountability.

Leading Change Without Losing the Human Being

A practical approach to organisational transformation that honours culture, emotion, dignity and performance.

From Strategy to Service

Turning plans, governance and performance systems into visible value for citizens, customers and communities.

The Power of Human Stories

Why memory, voice and courageous conversation matter in leadership, culture and social healing.

Burnout: When Expenditure Exceeds Replenishment

Recognising depletion, rebuilding boundaries and returning to sustainable effectiveness.

Purpose, Resilience and Legacy

How adversity can be integrated into a life of contribution, meaning and hope.

ENGAGEMENT FORMATS

Keynotes • Executive Facilitation • Conference Moderation • Panel Participation • Leadership Programmes • Executive Education • Coaching & Mentoring • Media Interviews • Podcasts & Broadcast Conversations • Master of Ceremonies • Organisational Consulting

EDUCATION

Year	Qualification
2021	Diploma in Occupational Hygiene
2021	Diploma in Workplace Safety and Health
2020	Diploma in Construction Safety
1998	Bachelor of Technology (BTech): Environmental Health
1991	National Diploma: Public Health

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS & DEVELOPMENT

- ❖ Certified NeuroCoach Mastery Coach — Neuro Coach Institute (2023)
- ❖ Certified Neuro-Linguistic Programming (NLP) Practitioner (2024)
- ❖ Certified multiBrain Integration Technique (mBIT) Practitioner (2024)
- ❖ Project Management — Rhodes University and University of Stellenbosch
- ❖ Practical Environmental Impact Assessment — North-West University (2009)
- ❖ Management Development Programme (2002)
- ❖ Advanced International Training in Waste Management — Chalmers University, Sweden (2000)
- ❖ ISO 45001:2018 principles and ISO management-system audit techniques
- ❖ Ethics in the Public Sector; Know and Live Our Constitution; Championing Anti-Discrimination
- ❖ Media Studies: Entertainment and Broadcasting Media; Podcasting Essentials
- ❖ Family Counselling, Marriage and Couples
- ❖ Occupational hygiene, hazard recognition, chemical safety and construction safety development

BOARD, COMMUNITY & SERVICE LEADERSHIP

- ❖ Chairperson — Lingomso Development Project (NPO)
- ❖ Chairperson — Iingcinga Foundation (October 2020 - 2025)
- ❖ Chairperson: Finance Committee — Cambridge Youth Society (from February 2024)
- ❖ Non-Executive Director — African Infrastructure, Mining and Agriculture Council
- ❖ Former First Secretary — Whittlesea Development Forum
- ❖ Committee service in environmental monitoring and the Institute of Waste Management of Southern Africa

LANGUAGES & ADDITIONAL CREDENTIALS

Languages: English, isiXhosa and isiZulu. Licensed global property practitioner. Code 08 and Code 10 military driving licence. Computer literate in Microsoft Office.

CLOSING POSITIONING STATEMENT

Simphiwe Gwana offers The SpeakersFirm a rare combination: executive substance, facilitator discipline, broadcast presence, coaching depth and an unforgettable personal story. He does not simply speak at an audience. He creates a room in which people recognise themselves, confront what must change and leave with language for their next courageous step.

SUGGESTED PUBLIC DESCRIPTOR

Executive Leadership Facilitator | Broadcaster | Coach | Curator of Human Stories